



## PROGRESS REPORT

# Rural digital data capture: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-26

Edition of 2026-08-27 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

13 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

ESWATINI · LESOTHO · MALAWI · MALI · MOROCCO · NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SIERRA LEONE · TOGO · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

## Eswatini

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                           | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-26                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT          |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| USSD access to public services                 | Did not exist | Planned for the 2027 rollout                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ADVANCED          |
| Agricultural extension officer digital devices | Not held      | 40 tablets and 4 laptops, valued at E313,504, handed to agricultural extension officers on 10 August 2026 under an IFAD and Green Climate Fund-backed project, for real-time crop, livestock and weather reporting by officers working with smallholder farmers across all four regions | BASELINE NOT HELD |

## Lesotho

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-26                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| T-Connect Impact school and clinic connectivity | Did not exist | Operating, following the first community hotspots handed over at Matsieng, Thaba Bosiu and Mokhotlong in September 2025 | ADVANCED |

## Malawi

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                       | AT 2025-08-01               | AT 2026-08-26                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| University AI fertigation facility, Thyolo | Did not exist at 2025-08-01 | The Malawi University of Science and Technology commissioned an AI-powered fertigation system automating irrigation and fertiliser application from real-time crop-growth data at its Thyolo campus, with an AI-assisted smart tree nursery, under a continental agricultural-universities programme | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                             | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | AT 2026-08-26                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT  |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>National Agricultural Data Infrastructure</b> | A multi-stakeholder dialogue on national data infrastructure for climate decision-making held in Malawi in September 2023, drawing conclusions on digitising paper records, standardising collection and embedding interoperability; nothing built | Farmers across 14 districts still use non-interoperable platforms - the meteorological department's, an agricultural NGO's, the government farm input subsidy programme's and a commodity exchange's - logging into each separately; the harmonising framework remains a proposal and a farmer-ID layer on the national register remains an argument, not a system | NO CHANGE |

## Mali

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                 | AT 2025-08-01               | AT 2026-08-26                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Rural and white-zone coverage</b> | No white-zone map published | An updated universal-access strategy with a white-zone map recommended, against a 2030 universal connectivity target | ADVANCED |

## Morocco

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | AT 2025-08-01                                                           | AT 2026-08-26                                                                      | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Mobile identity enrolment units</b>              | 80 units, more than 130,000 citizens served (2024)                      | Same; no later figure held                                                         | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Registry extension to rural and remote areas</b> | Extension via digital and remote applications, targets stated (2024-12) | Same; the end-2024 target date has passed with no delivery or coverage figure held | NO CHANGE |

## Namibia

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | AT 2025-08-01                                             | AT 2026-08-26                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Satellite connectivity partnership with Angola</b> | A proof of concept under way; discussions began June 2025 | A pilot commercial agreement between the state fixed operator and Angola's space agency, with full commercial launch targeted after the pilot | ADVANCED |

## Niger

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-26                                                         | MOVEMENT |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Villages Intelligents rural inclusion programme</b> | Did not exist | One centre on record, with women's and girls' digital skills training | ADVANCED |

## Nigeria

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-26                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Cisco AI for smallholder farmers</b> | Did not exist     | Exploratory; no programme, funding, timeline or counterparty ministry named                                    | ADVANCED |
| <b>Rural connectivity programmes</b>    | Baseline not held | About 3,700 towers to start deploying around October 2026 against 23% of rural communities connected (2025-10) | ADVANCED |

## Rwanda

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT         | AT 2025-08-01                                              | AT 2026-08-26                                                                                | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| School internet connectivity | 3,082 schools connected in 2023/24, about 62% by late 2024 | 4,184 of 4,996 connected with 812 outstanding, rural at about 27% against urban at about 75% | ADVANCED |

## Sierra Leone

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                             | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Agricultural interactive voice response platform | Not held      | An upgraded interactive voice response platform reported 98% complete, to give farmers direct access to agriculture ministry officials under the national food-security agenda | BASELINE NOT HELD |

## Togo

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                             | AT 2025-08-01                                                                  | AT 2026-08-26                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Spectrum royalties for satellite and machine-to-machine services | The 2023 rate schedule in force, with no satellite or machine-to-machine rates | Amendment adopted to price spectrum use for satellite services and satellite machine-to-machine traffic, so specialised operators can establish and rural connectivity extend; the text and its rates were unpublished at 2026-07-31 | ADVANCED |

## Zambia

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                           | AT 2025-08-01                                                        | AT 2026-08-26                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Satellite terminals in rural public facilities | Kits deployed in underserved public facilities since 2024, year only | A rural health clinic and two primary schools connected for access to government services through the national portal; no national count of connected facilities published | ADVANCED |

## Zimbabwe

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Rural network population coverage            | BASELINE NOT HELD | 5G reaches 0.0% of the rural population against 18.9% nationally; 3G reaches 73.7%; 4,681 of 13,104 base stations are rural                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Baseline not held |
| School connectivity and solar programme      | Not held          | 11,500 satellite terminals distributed to schools - 8,000 to those with no wireless network and a further 3,500 to those already connected - with more than 1,300 institutions still to reach and a stated target of internet connectivity, solar power and national-grid access at every school by December 2026; cabinet has separately committed 3% of GDP to research and innovation under the education framework | BASELINE NOT HELD |
| Universal services fund subscription support | BASELINE NOT HELD | One year of subscription support for digital centres and schools, with extension to rural health centres said to be under consideration; no fund size or disbursement figure held                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Baseline not held |

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EDITION         | 2026-08-27                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| CURRENT EDITION | <a href="https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/digital-rural/digital-rural-progress.html">https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/digital-rural/digital-rural-progress.html</a>                     |
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.